

Page 1 - Intake and Emergency Department

On January 8, 2023, Maria Lopez slipped on a wet loading dock at work and reported immediate low back pain and right wrist pain.

On 01/08/2023, City Emergency Department evaluated Ms. Lopez for back and wrist pain after the fall.

X-rays performed on January 8, 2023 showed no acute fracture of the lumbar spine or right wrist.

The patient was discharged by City Emergency Department with ibuprofen and instructions to follow up with occupational medicine.

The intake form lists prior intermittent back pain in 2021 without regular treatment.

Page 2 - Occupational Medicine

On January 12, 2023, WorkWell Occupational Medicine saw the patient for persistent lumbar pain and right wrist soreness.

Dr. Aaron Kim diagnosed lumbar strain and right wrist sprain on January 12, 2023.

WorkWell Occupational Medicine placed the patient on modified duty with no lifting over 10 pounds starting January 12, 2023.

Follow up was recommended in 2 weeks.

Page 3 - Duplicate Notice and Month-Level History

The claim summary states that in February 2023 the patient continued to report low back pain while awaiting therapy authorization.

On February 2, 2023, WorkWell Occupational Medicine noted continued lumbar pain and ordered physical therapy.

The employer note repeats: On February 2, 2023, physical therapy was ordered for ongoing lumbar strain by WorkWell Occupational Medicine.

No appointment occurred on February 2023; this is a month-level status note only.

Page 4 - Physical Therapy Start

Physical therapy started on February 10, 2023 at Metro Rehab Clinic.

On February 10, 2023, Metro Rehab Clinic performed an initial physical therapy evaluation for lumbar strain.

The patient attended physical therapy two times per week from February 10, 2023 through March 24, 2023.

By March 24, 2023, Metro Rehab Clinic documented improved range of motion but persistent pain with lifting.

Page 5 - Imaging

An MRI of the lumbar spine performed on April 5, 2023 at Northside Imaging showed a mild L4-L5 disc bulge without nerve compression.

Northside Imaging faxed the MRI report on April 7, 2023.

The April 2023 MRI was reviewed later by Dr. Kim; this sentence intentionally has month-level timing.

Page 6 - Treatment Gap and Specialist

On May 2, 2023, Dr. Aaron Kim reviewed the MRI and continued modified duty restrictions.

There is no documented treatment between May 2, 2023 and June 20, 2023.

On June 20, 2023, SpineCare Associates evaluated the patient for persistent low back pain.

SpineCare Associates recommended a lumbar epidural steroid injection on June 20, 2023.

Page 7 - Procedure and Return to Work

On July 6, 2023, Valley Pain Center performed a lumbar epidural steroid injection.

The procedure note states the patient tolerated the injection without complication.

On July 28, 2023, SpineCare Associates reported 50 percent pain improvement after the injection.

SpineCare Associates released the patient to light duty on July 28, 2023.

Page 8 - Flare and Additional Duplicate

On August 16, 2023, the patient reported increased pain after lifting boxes at work.

Dr. Aaron Kim took the patient off work on August 16, 2023 pending reevaluation.

The adjuster summary repeats that on August 16, 2023, Dr. Kim removed the patient from work because of increased pain after lifting boxes.

Page 9 - MMI

On October 3, 2023, Dr. Aaron Kim found the patient at maximum medical improvement. Dr. Aaron Kim assigned a 7 percent whole person impairment rating on October 3, 2023. The patient was released to full duty effective October 9, 2023.

Page 10 - Ambiguous and Administrative Notes

The records mention a missed appointment on 3/4/23; the clinic location is unclear.

A billing review occurred on November 1, 2023 and should not be treated as a medical treatment event if possible.

On November 15, 2023, WorkWell Occupational Medicine issued a final narrative report summarizing the injury and treatment.